At Rezang-la, the Chinese were taking casualties, so they prematurely called for artillery support while it was still dark. Their guns opened up, as did their MMGs and mortars that had been positioned earlier in the night. However, the firing was ineffective as the forward observers were unable to guide the guns accurately. As the battle raged, at 6.30 a.m. the Delta Company patrol reached the area through which the Chinese had advanced and where they had kept their reserves. The patrol was spotted and the Chinese opened fire, killing Roop Ram and two others instantly. Sepoy Ram Singh, despite being hit by splinters, managed to duck into the rocks. With the attention of the Chinese on Rezang-la, Ram Singh slipped away after a while.

The original H-Hour for the Chinese to open fire on all the Indian positions in the Chushul sector was 6.30 a.m. The batteries in support of the troops at Rezang-la had been forced to open fire early, and Chinese guns had also engaged Bravo Company of 13 Kumaon at Paw Hill an hour earlier, but now the entire front came alive. The barrage on the Gorkha positions on Gurung Hill, Gurung Hill (Crest), Trench Hill and Foot Hill was particularly severe.

The Chinese bombardment across all positions meant Rezang-la was not only isolated, it was also on the back burner as the commanding officers, Lieutenant Colonel H.S. Dhingra at 13 Kumaon HQ and Raina at 114 Brigade HQ grappled with more immediate issues. As the light improved at Rezang-la, the Chinese forward observers came into play and the bombardment became far more effective. With clearer visibility, the Chinese threw everything at their disposal to blast out Shaitan Singh’s men. Apart from heavy artillery that systematically blew up the stone sangars, the Chinese lined up 132 mm rockets, 120 mm heavy mortars, 81 and 60 mm medium mortars, and 75 and 53 mm RCL guns in a direct firing role. Throughout the barrage not one Kumaonis soldier wavered, each man holding his position until he was killed.

As the bombardment intensified, the Chinese threw in their infantry reserve, which joined those who had taken cover when the Kumaonis had opened up. Both No. 7 and No. 8 Platoon had been overrun by 7.30 a.m. hours, but those still alive continued to fight.

With two of his platoons all but wiped out, Shaitan Singh along with his company havildar major, Phool Singh, and two other men decided to join up with No. 9 Platoon, some 550 metres away. Hardly had they covered